

Cardholder Data Environment Logging Standard

Technical standard | STD-CDE-LOG-010

Document owner	Payment Security Lead
Effective date	2026-04-12
Applicable reference	PCI-DSS v4.0 Req 10.2 - Audit logs capture user activities and security events

Scope and purpose

All system components in the cardholder data environment, and all security-relevant services connected to it, generate audit events needed to detect, alert on, and analyze anomalous activity and potential compromise. The standard applies to payment APIs, databases, operating systems, firewalls, administrative consoles, and identity services.

Required events

Logs record successful and failed user authentication, user access to cardholder-data repositories, administrator authentication and commands, creation and deletion of accounts, changes to privileges, changes to audit configuration, and security tool alerts. Events include the user or service identity, timestamp, source, action, target, and outcome. PAN is not written to application logs.

Detection and alerting

Systems forward events to the central SIEM within five minutes. Correlation rules alert the Security Operations Center on repeated failures, access outside an approved window, privilege changes, disabled logging, unusual administrative activity, and suspicious payment-service behavior. Analysts preserve the event set with the incident record for investigation.

Validation

Payment Security tests log generation and SIEM ingestion monthly using controlled user and administrator actions. The 30 June 2026 test confirmed coverage for 100 percent of 64 in-scope system components.